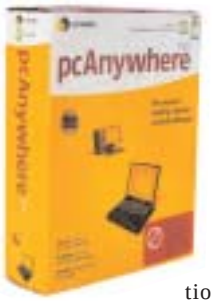
Symantec pcAnywhere 10.5

Take your PC wherever you go

Symantec pcAnywhere 10.5 is a 32-bit Windows-based application that allows users to collaborate across networks. Users can view their desktop from a remote computer or transfer files across networks. Other features include configuration of rebootless Host PC and gateways. pcAnywhere can connect to desktops using various interfaces such as dial-up ISDN, IPX, TCP/IP and infrared. We tested it using a 100 Mbps Ethernet connection on our Intranet.



The installation is quite simple—you can choose between a wide range of options such as Host Only, Remote Only and Complete. The manual gives detailed information about configuring hosts and remote clients using various connection types. The Symantec Web site has a decent collection of tutorials that are of great help.

The provided SpeedSend file transfer is extremely useful and swift. This is primarily because the utility detects and sends only that data which has changed since the previous transfer.

Data can be encrypted using public key, symmetric or pcAnywhere's encryption methods. Of these methods, pcAnywhere's encryption is the most simple and basic.

The excellent security, data encryption and logging facilities provided by Symantec pcAnywhere 10.5 make it ideal for enterprise setups.

SPECIFICATIONS

Requirements: Pentium 233 MHz, 64 MB RAM, Windows 98SE/Me/NT/2000/XP
Package contents: One installation CD, User manual

Symantec pcAnywhere 10.5	A-
Performance	
Ease of Use	
Value for money	
Features	
OVERALL	

Price: Rs 15,525
Contact: Symantec India
Phone: 022-26570658
Fax: 022-26570671
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Web site: www.symantec.com

Toon Boom Studio V2

Cartoonist at work

Toon Boom Studio V2 is 2D animation software that helps create cool animations with great ease. The program depends on QuickTime 5, so you just need to install the player provided with the CD.



A tutorial familiarises you with the features of the software. The creation of pictures for every animation is pretty easy. The user has to create a single drawing and then onwards create drawings with respect to the previous frame. The previous drawing is visible on the Drawing View for easy reference while you draw the picture for the next step.

Apart from drawing and painting, you can even insert sound elements. If the sound element is a dialogue, then you can animate the lip movements of the animation. You can make new lip states or just use the ones automatically generated by the program. You can even make multiple scenes, apply cross-dissolves between frames with colour transform elements, and create clipping mask effects.

Cartoonist and Web designers will find the Toon Boom Studio a true boon, especially with the added facility to export to Shockwave files. Taking into account the price factor, this is definitely a good investment for professionals.

Price: Rs 20,000
Contact: Rahul Commerce
Phone: 9520-6113853
Fax: 9520-6127752
E-mail: rahulsales@vsnl.com
Web site: www.toonboom.com

SPECIFICATIONS

System Requirements: 233 MHz CPU, Windows 98/2000/XP/Me, 128 MB RAM, 100 MB hard disk space, 1024 x 768, 24-bit colour display with 8 MB of video RAM

Toon Boom Studio V2	B+
Performance	
Ease of Use	
Value for money	
Features	
OVERALL	

Super Monocular Digi Cam

Souped-up magnifying device

The Super Monocular has an in-built lens that allows you to take pictures of far-away objects, and a viewfinder with a thumb-wheel focal adjustment. The user interface comprises a mode key and shutter button. The mode can be seen on the two-digit, alpha numeric, LCD screen. You have to refer to the key in the operational guide to figure out the meaning of the displayed digits.



The camera produces a barely-audible beep upon clicking and the only way to confirm is by keeping track of the photographs taken displayed on the LCD. The focal adjustment is not very flexible and allows you to take photographs of objects situated less than five metres away.

To download your photographs, connect the camera to the USB port, install the drivers and software from the CD.

The quality of the photographs leaves a lot to be desired—edges are not sharp and the detail level is quite low; there is no provision for light adjustment either. The camera can also be used to capture live images to the PC, but the limited focal adjustment does not allow much flexibility. The images are also marred with vexing red and blue dots, and a low frame rate. About the only thing it's got going for it is the large amount of memory—64 MB.

Overall, the Digi Cam is not a great buy given its low versatility, poor image and build quality.

Price: Rs 6,500
Contact: Compact International
Phone: 022-26923743
Fax: 022-26281751
E-mail: sales@compact-international.com
Web site: www.compact-international.com

SPECIFICATIONS

1.3 Megapixel picture resolution, 8x zoom, 7.8 mm angular field of view, 64 MB memory, two AAA batteries, USB interface, compatible with Windows 98SE/Me/2000/XP

Super Monocular Digi Cam	B-
Performance	
Build Quality	
Value for money	
Features	
OVERALL	